

C210

Management and Leadership Capstone

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A hospital operations director with a background in engineering builds next year's staffing budget, sets shift schedules, and tracks overtime against targets each week. Her office is next to the cafeteria. Which function is she mainly performing?

- A. Leadership.
- B. Leadership, because she holds a director title.
- C. Management.
- D. Neither; engineers perform technical work, not management.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

During a heated budget meeting in the downtown office, a finance manager feels angry when a peer criticizes her forecast. She pauses, takes a breath, and asks the peer to walk through the concern before replying. She has worked at the firm for seven years. Which emotional intelligence component is she showing?

- A. Self-regulation.
- B. Self-awareness only.
- C. Motivation.
- D. Empathy.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A software team lead begins each week by asking members what is blocking them, then clears those obstacles and arranges training they request. She still sets the release date and makes final calls on scope. The team won an internal hackathon last spring. Which style best describes her?

- A. Servant leadership.
- B. Autocratic leadership, because she sets the release date.
- C. Transactional leadership, since the team wins contests.
- D. Laissez-faire leadership.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A city is planning a new transit line. The regional transportation board can approve or cancel funding but has shown little interest in the details. The project office is in a historic building and has a staff of 22. How should the project manager treat the board?

- A. Keep satisfied.
- B. Manage closely with weekly detailed briefings.
- C. Monitor only.
- D. Keep informed.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A neighborhood group cares intensely about a new warehouse project but has no approval authority or funding role. Which grid strategy fits?

- A. Keep satisfied.
- B. Keep informed.
- C. Ignore them, since they have no authority.
- D. Manage closely.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A plant manager must pick a new supplier within 48 hours after the current one went bankrupt. She reviews three suppliers she already knows, chooses the first that meets quality and delivery minimums, and moves on. The plant makes auto parts and runs three shifts. What decision pattern is this?

- A. Escalation of commitment.
- B. Groupthink.
- C. Rational optimizing.
- D. Satisficing under bounded rationality.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A sales team is offered a \$10,000 bonus, which every rep says they want, for doubling sales in one quarter. Reps believe the target is impossible in the current market. The company recently redesigned its logo and moved to a new CRM. Using expectancy theory, what is the likely effect on motivation?

- A. High, once the new CRM is in place.
- B. High, because the reward is highly valued.
- C. Moderate, because high valence and low expectancy average out.
- D. Low, because expectancy is near zero and the factors multiply.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A manager rates a team's expectancy at 0.9, instrumentality at 0.8, and valence at 0.1. Which change would raise motivation the most?

- A. Promise the reward more firmly.
- B. Offer a reward the team actually values.
- C. Nothing; $0.9 + 0.8 + 0.1 = 1.8$ is already strong.
- D. Make the target easier to reach.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A CEO must decide whether to close a plant. Closing it would save \$30 million and protect 4,000 jobs elsewhere in the company by keeping the firm solvent, while cutting 600 local jobs. She chooses to close it because it produces the most benefit for the most people. The plant has a strong safety record. Which framework is she using?

- A. Justice-based.
- B. Rights-based.
- C. Rights-based, because the plant is safe.
- D. Utilitarian.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A manager refuses to share customer data with a partner even though doing so would raise profits for everyone involved, because customers never gave consent. Which framework is the manager applying?

- A.** Utilitarian.
- B.** Egoism.
- C.** Rights-based.
- D.** Justice-based.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A retail chain wants an early warning of rising staff turnover so it can act before people quit. It has 120 stores, a new CEO, and last year's turnover was 62%. Which measure is the best leading indicator?

- A.** Last year's 62% turnover rate.
- B.** Quarterly employee engagement scores by store.
- C.** Number of exit interviews completed.
- D.** Annual revenue per store.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A manager's dashboard shows net profit, annual customer churn, and year-end turnover. What kind of indicators are these?

- A.** A mix: net profit is lagging; churn and turnover are leading.
- B.** Leading indicators.
- C.** Lagging indicators.
- D.** Neither; only financial measures count as indicators.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A hospital operations director ~~with a background in engineering~~ builds next year's staffing budget, sets shift schedules, and tracks overtime against targets each week. ~~Her office is next to the cafeteria.~~ Which function is she mainly performing?

Target word: management or leadership **Decides:** Planning, budgeting, and controlling bring order.

A	Confusion set	Leadership sets direction and motivates change; this work creates order.
B	Adjacent category	Rank does not define the function performed.
C	Correct	Budgeting, scheduling, and control against targets cope with complexity.
D	Camouflage	Her background does not decide the function.

2. Answer A Concept 2

During a heated budget meeting ~~in the downtown office~~, a finance manager feels angry when a peer criticizes her forecast. She pauses, takes a breath, and asks the peer to walk through the concern before replying. ~~She has worked at the firm for seven years.~~ Which emotional intelligence component is she showing?

Target word: name the EI component **Decides:** She controls her own emotional reaction.

A	Correct	Managing her own anger before responding is self-regulation.
B	Dropped element	She notices her anger, but the key act is controlling it.
C	Confusion set	Motivation is internal drive toward goals.
D	Confusion set	Empathy is reading others' emotions; she is managing her own.

3. Answer A Concept 3

A software team lead begins each week by asking members what is blocking them, then clears those obstacles and arranges training they request. She still sets the release date and makes final calls on scope. ~~The team won an internal hackathon last spring.~~ Which style best describes her?

Target word: name the style **Decides:** She puts team needs and growth first while still deciding.

A	Correct	Serving followers' needs to enable performance defines it; deciding is still part of the role.
B	Dropped element	Drops her listening and obstacle-removal behaviors.
C	Camouflage	The hackathon result does not identify her style.
D	Adjacent category	She is highly involved and makes decisions.

4. Answer A Concept 4

A city is planning a new transit line. The regional transportation board can approve or cancel funding but has shown little interest in the details. ~~The project office is in a historic building and has a staff of 22.~~ How should the project manager treat the board?

Target word: grid strategy **Decides:** High power, low interest.

A	Correct	High-power, low-interest stakeholders get enough attention to stay satisfied without heavy detail.
B	Adjacent category	That is for high power and high interest; this board is not engaged.
C	Dropped element	Drops their power over funding.
D	Inverted operation	That strategy is for low power, high interest — the axes reversed.

5. Answer B Concept 4 • transfer

A neighborhood group cares intensely about a new warehouse project but has no approval authority or funding role. Which grid strategy fits?

Target word: grid strategy for low power, high interest **Decides:** Low power, high interest.

A	Inverted operation	That is for high power and low interest.
B	Correct	Interested but low-power groups get regular updates.
C	Absolute language	High-interest groups can gain power; they should be kept informed.
D	Adjacent category	Reserved for key players with high power and interest.

6. Answer D Concept 5

A plant manager must pick a new supplier within 48 hours after the current one went bankrupt. She reviews three suppliers she already knows, chooses the first that meets quality and delivery minimums, and moves on. ~~The plant makes auto parts and runs three shifts.~~ What decision pattern is this?

Target word: name the pattern **Decides:** Time limits and first acceptable option.

A	Confusion set	That is sticking with a failing course; she is making a new choice.
B	Adjacent category	Groupthink is a team dynamic; she decided alone.
C	Inverted operation	Optimizing reviews all options for the best; she stopped at the first acceptable one.
D	Correct	Limited time and information lead to choosing a good-enough option.

7. Answer D Concept 6

A sales team is offered a \$10,000 bonus, which every rep says they want, for doubling sales in one quarter. Reps believe the target is impossible in the current market. ~~The company recently redesigned its logo and moved to a new CRM.~~ Using expectancy theory, what is the likely effect on motivation?

Target word: motivation outcome **Decides:** Expectancy is near zero.

A	Camouflage	The tool change does not alter the belief that the target is impossible.
B	Dropped element	Drops expectancy; high valence cannot offset an impossible target.
C	Inverted operation	Treats the factors as added instead of multiplied.
D	Correct	If effort cannot produce the result, a valued reward cannot rescue motivation.

8. Answer B Concept 6 • transfer

A manager rates a team's expectancy at 0.9, instrumentality at 0.8, and valence at 0.1. Which change would raise motivation the most?

Target word: which factor to fix **Decides:** Valence is the weakest multiplier.

A	Confusion set	Instrumentality is already 0.8.
B	Correct	$0.9 \times 0.8 \times 0.1 = 0.072$; raising the weakest factor, valence, has the largest effect.
C	Inverted operation	Adds instead of multiplies; the product is only 0.072.
D	Adjacent category	Expectancy is already high at 0.9.

9. Answer D Concept 7

A CEO must decide whether to close a plant. Closing it would save \$30 million and protect 4,000 jobs elsewhere in the company by keeping the firm solvent, while cutting 600 local jobs. She chooses to close it because it produces the most benefit for the most people. ~~The plant has a strong safety record.~~ Which framework is she using?

Target word: name the framework **Decides:** She weighs total outcomes across all affected.

A	Confusion set	Justice focuses on fair distribution and process.
B	Confusion set	Rights reasoning protects individuals regardless of totals.
C	Camouflage	The safety record does not drive her reasoning.
D	Correct	Greatest good for the greatest number is utilitarian reasoning.

10. Answer C Concept 7 • transfer

A manager refuses to share customer data with a partner even though doing so would raise profits for everyone involved, because customers never gave consent. Which framework is the manager applying?

Target word: framework from reasoning **Decides:** Protecting individual rights over total benefit.

A	Inverted operation	Utilitarian reasoning would favor the total profit gain — the opposite of this choice.
B	Confusion set	Egoism serves the decision maker's self-interest.
C	Correct	Consent and privacy rights override the aggregate gain.
D	Adjacent category	Justice concerns fair distribution, not consent.

11. Answer B Concept 8

A retail chain wants an early warning of rising staff turnover so it can act before people quit. ~~It has 120 stores, a new CEO,~~ and last year's turnover was 62%. Which measure is the best leading indicator?

Target word: leading indicator **Decides:** A measure that predicts future turnover.

A	Wrong stem number	A lagging result, already happened.
B	Correct	Falling engagement predicts future quits and can be acted on early.
C	Adjacent category	Exit interviews happen after people leave; lagging.
D	Confusion set	A lagging financial outcome, not a predictor of turnover.

12. Answer C Concept 8 • transfer

A manager's dashboard shows net profit, annual customer churn, and year-end turnover. What kind of indicators are these?

Target word: classify indicators **Decides:** All report results after they happen.

A	Adjacent category	Annual churn and year-end turnover are also after-the-fact results.
B	Inverted operation	Leading indicators predict future outcomes; these report past ones.
C	Correct	They describe outcomes already realized.
D	Absolute language	Nonfinancial measures are indicators too.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	9	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	2	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	9	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	4	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Management vs. leadership	Management copes with complexity through planning, budgeting, organizing, and control; leadership copes with change through setting direction, aligning people, and motivating them.	Treating leadership as a higher rank of management rather than a different function.	Whether the task is bringing order and predictability or setting direction and inspiring change.
2	Emotional intelligence	Emotional intelligence includes self-awareness, self-regulation, motivation, empathy, and social skill; self-regulation is controlling one's own impulses and moods.	Confusing empathy (reading others) with self-regulation (managing oneself).	Whether the behavior is about one's own emotions or other people's.
3	Servant leadership	Servant leaders put followers' growth and well-being first, listening and removing obstacles so people can perform; authority serves the team.	Mistaking servant leadership for being passive or avoiding decisions.	A leader whose main question is what the team needs to succeed.
4	Stakeholder power-interest grid	High power/high interest: manage closely; high power/low interest: keep satisfied; low power/high interest: keep informed; low power/low interest: monitor.	Spending the most effort on the loudest group regardless of power.	Two facts about the stakeholder: ability to affect the project and level of concern.
5	Bounded rationality and satisficing	Managers decide with limited time, information, and attention, so they often choose the first option that meets minimum criteria (satisficing) instead of the optimal one.	Assuming real managers evaluate every alternative to find the best.	A deadline plus incomplete information and a choice of a "good enough" option.
6	Expectancy theory	Motivation = expectancy (effort leads to performance) × instrumentality (performance leads to reward) × valence (value of the reward); if any factor is near zero, motivation collapses.	Adding the factors so a high reward offsets a belief that the target is impossible.	An attractive reward paired with an unreachable target, or a reachable target with a reward nobody wants.
7	Ethical decision frameworks	Utilitarian reasoning picks the greatest good for the greatest number; rights-based reasoning protects individual rights regardless of outcomes; justice reasoning seeks fair distribution and fair process.	Labeling any ethical choice "utilitarian" because it seems sensible.	What the decision maker appeals to: outcomes, rights, or fairness.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
8	Leading vs. lagging indicators	Lagging indicators report results after the fact (revenue, turnover); leading indicators predict future results and can be acted on early (engagement scores, pipeline).	Using only lagging results to manage performance in real time.	Whether the measure shows an outcome already achieved or a driver of a future one.

Course scope (public description): This course is the culminating assessment of the MSML curriculum that provides an integrative experience with all competencies and assessment topics throughout the program. Students synthesize concepts from previously completed coursework and demonstrate an understanding of management and leadership development and practices.